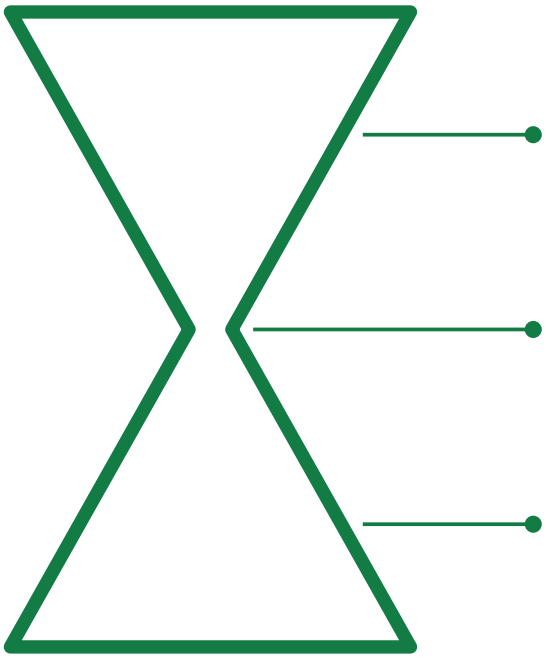
The Argument Hourglass

Write a thesis argument that holds up

A free four-week online clinic for music postgraduates.



The wide opening Sentence 1

What is changing in your field, and what is missing from it.

The narrow middle Sentence 2

One research question: your approach, your boundaries and your evidence.

The wide base Sentence 3

Your answer, then its possible wider impact, at the same scale as the problem you opened with.

Who it is for

Fourth-year, honours, masters and doctoral music students: whether you are writing a proposal, a half-thesis or a full thesis.

How it works

Four weeks, four students, online. Each week you write one sentence that stands for a whole section of the hourglass. Together, your three sentences state the argument of your entire proposal or thesis. I score each one, and we rewrite it together in your own 12-minute slot.

I coach how your argument is built. I do not edit or write for you, and I do not replace your supervisor.

Free pilot places, starting early 2027

Scan to apply, or visit johnoosthuizen.com

Dr John Oosthuizen, PhD (Music) · john@johnoosthuizen.com